

Chapter 43

Take Selectors, Compound Clips, and Nested Timelines

This chapter covers a variety of different ways you can turn multiple clips into a single object in the Timeline, to accommodate a variety of different editing tasks.

Take Selectors, compound clips, and nested timelines all appear as a single clip in the Timeline, but they all organize multiple clips in different ways. Take Selectors let you organize multiple clips vertically, making it easy to associate clips with one another so you can easily switch among them. Compound clips and nested timelines let you organize multiple clips horizontally, so that you can manage long or short sequences of clips within an edit as a single clip, when convenient.

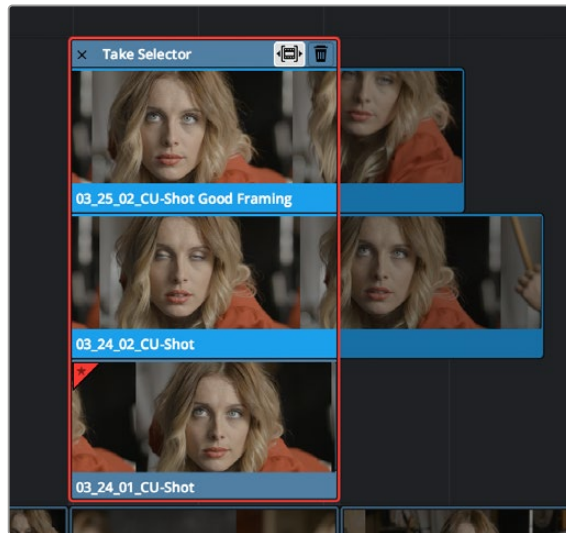
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Take Selectors

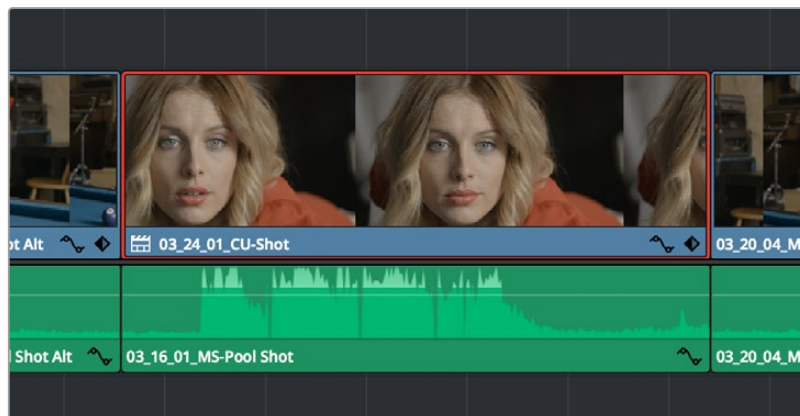
Take Selectors in DaVinci Resolve provide a way for you to manage multiple takes or versions of a particular clip in the Timeline. They're ideal for storing multiple useful takes for scenes where you or the client can't quite decide which one is the best, or for maintaining multiple versions of VFX clips that are going through different iterations.

When you place a number of clips inside a Take Selector, only one clip appears in the Timeline, but you can open that Take Selector and switch to any other take or version that's stored within to switch which clip appears in the Timeline whenever you want.



A Take Selector, shown open, with several alternate takes placed within

Take selectors are easy to create and use and populate. Once you've placed a number of clips inside the Take Selector, you can drag any take to slip that clip's range of media to synchronize it with the other takes, or click a take to choose that clip within the Take Selector to appear in the Timeline, before closing the Take Selector to confirm your change.



When closed, a Take Selector appears as a regular clip with a badge

When closed, multi-take clips can be edited, trimmed, composited, graded, and rendered like any other single clip in the Timeline. A Take Selector badge appears to the left of the name of a clip to which it's applied to show its status; double-clicking this badge opens the Take Selector so you can adjust its contents.

Methods of using Take Selectors:

- **To create a Take Selector:** Right-click any clip that's not a title or generator, and choose Take Selector from the contextual menu. The Take Selector interface appears, disabling the rest of the Timeline temporarily while you work with the Take Selector's contents.
- **To populate a Take Selector:** Drag any clip from the Media Pool into the Take Selector, and it appears "stacked" on top of the original clip in the Timeline.
- **To choose the current take:** Click any clip within the Take Selector so that it's highlighted, and then click the close button at the upper-left corner of the Take Selector. When next you open the Take Selector, the current clip appears at the bottom of the stack, with a star at the upper-left corner. Absent a choice, the current take will default to the last clip added to the Take Selector.
- **To set a Take Selector to ripple the Timeline when a longer or shorter take is selected:** Click the Ripple Take button, at the upper right-hand corner of the Take Selector panel, to the left of the trash can button. With this turned on, selecting a take that's longer or shorter than the current take will ripple the Timeline. With this turned off, selecting a take that's longer or shorter will either overwrite the next clip to the right, or leave a gap.
- **To slip a clip within the Take Selector:** Drag any clip to the left or right to slip the range of media that appears within the Take Selector's duration in the Timeline. This is useful for synchronizing other takes to fit the same narrative beat as the first take you used.
- **To remove a clip from a Take Selector:** Click the clip you want to remove to select it, then click the trash can button at the upper-right corner of the Take Selector. That take disappears from the Take Selector.
- **To close a Take Selector:** Click the X close button, or press the escape key. Whichever take was selected is now the clip that appears in the Timeline.
- **To reopen a Take Selector:** Double-click the Take Selector badge at the left of a clip's name, or right-click a multi-take clip and choose Take Selector from the contextual menu.
- **To eliminate a Take Selector leaving only the take you want:** Close the Take Selector, if open, then right-click that clip in the Timeline and choose Finalize Take from the contextual menu.

Compositing and Grading Take Selectors

Since compound clips act like a single clip in the Timeline, they appear as a single MediaIn node in the Fusion page, and you grade them as you would any other single clip in the Color page. However, for Take Selectors, the composite or grade is applied to the Take Selector itself; when you switch to any other take, it appears with the same composition and grade.

NOTE: Any keyframing you do is relative to the Timeline of the overall Take Selector. This means that if you create a keyframed effect in either the Fusion or Color pages using take 1, and you then switch to takes 2, 3, or 4, the timing might not be exactly the same and you might need to make some adjustments.

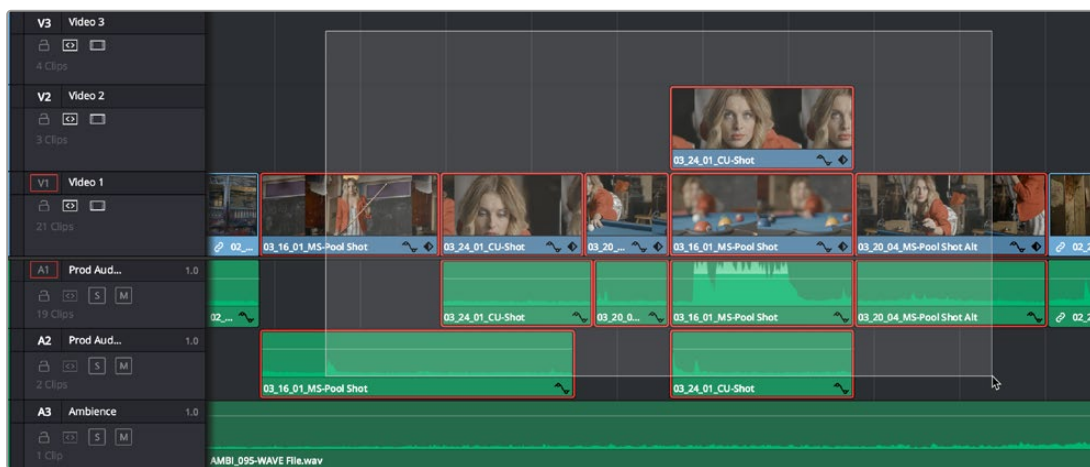
Compound Clips

You can select a series of clips in the Timeline, be they edited one after the other in serial or superimposed and stacked in parallel, and turn them into a compound clip, which is a single clip in the Timeline that's actually comprised of many other audio and video clips embedded inside. This allows you to work with a block of clips as if it were a single unit, governed by a single set of Inspector controls, and able to be connected to another clip in your timeline by a single transition.

Editing a compound clip works the same as editing any other type of clip. They can be edited, trimmed, and deleted using all the same methods. In addition, compound clips can be renamed, and decomposed back into their component clips right in the Timeline.

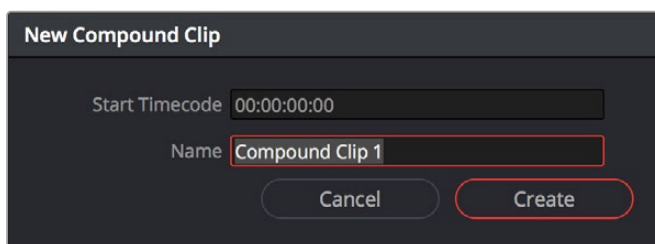
To create a compound clip by selection:

- 1 Select a range of clips.



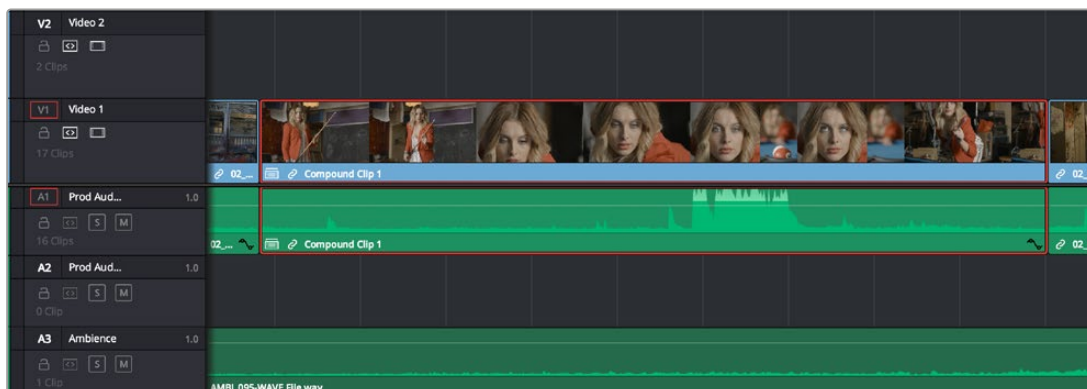
Selecting a range of clips to turn into a compound clip

- 2 Right-click one of the selected clips and choose New Compound Clip.
- 3 Enter an optional start timecode and a name, and click Create.



The New Compound Clip Properties dialog

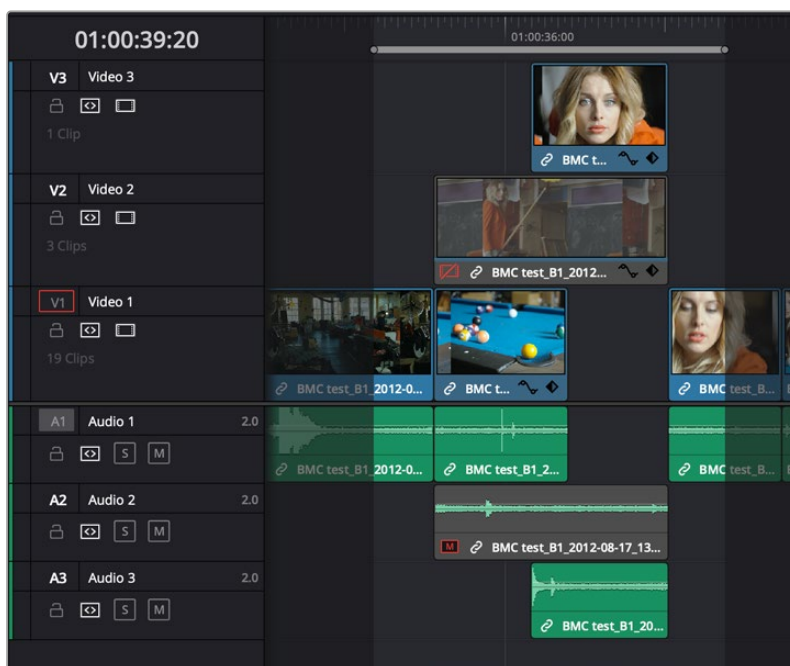
A compound clip is created which takes the place of the original clips you selected on the Timeline. Additionally, a copy of that compound clip appears in the currently selected bin of the Media Pool.



The resulting compound clip

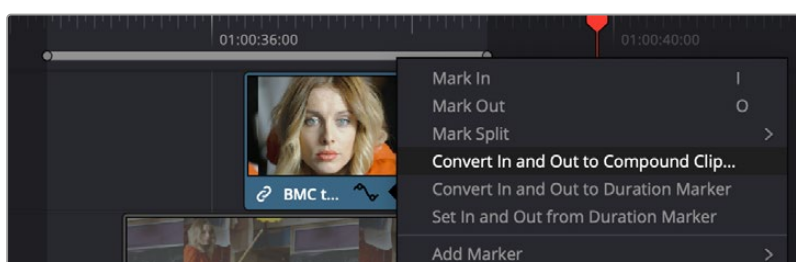
To create a compound clip by In-Out range:

- 1 Select a range of clips using In and Out points on the Timeline. This allows you to select partial sections of a clip to add to the compound, rather than the whole clip. All tracks between the In-Out range will be included, even if the track is disabled or auto select is off.



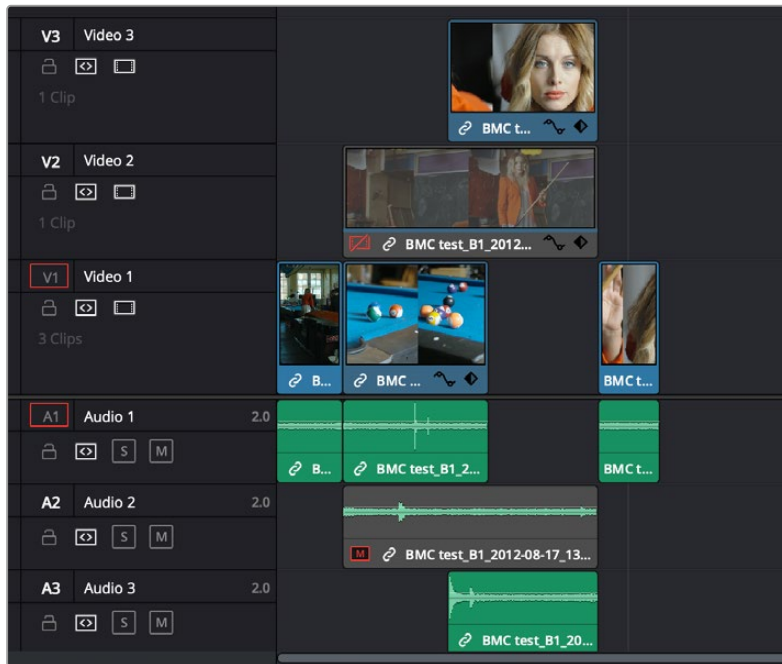
Selecting a range of clips based on In and Out points to turn into a compound clip. Note that this selection includes only parts of the first and last clips in the range.

- 2 Right-click on the timeline range and choose Convert In and Out to Compound Clip.



Right clicking on the In-Out range (gray bar) on the Timeline brings up the context menu.

- Enter an optional start timecode and a name, and click Create.



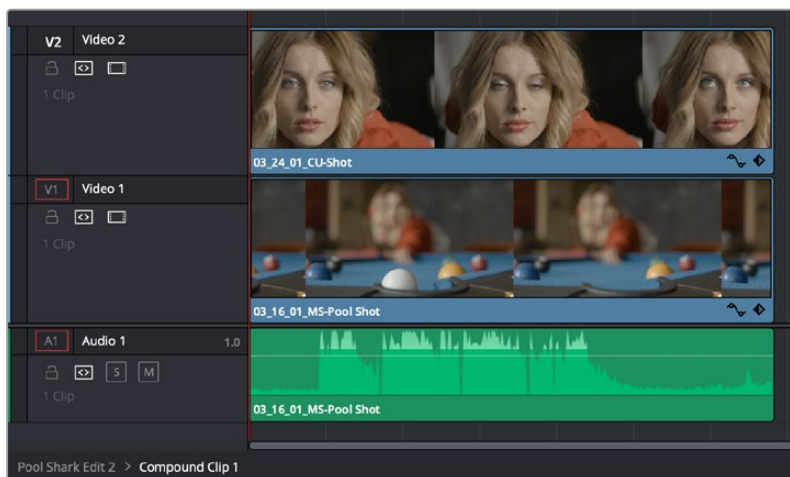
The resulting bounds of the compound clip showing only the media included in the exact In-Out range.

To rename a compound clip:

- Click the name of the compound clip twice in the Media Pool to select the name text. Type a new name, and press the Return key to accept the change.

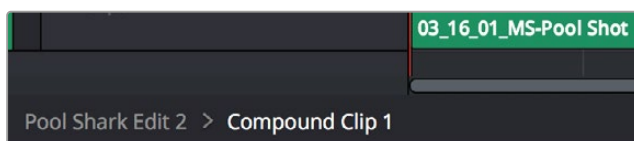
To edit a compound clip:

- Right-click any compound clip and choose Open in Timeline from the contextual menu. The Timeline updates with the contents of the compound clip, which you can re-edit at your discretion.



An open compound clip in the Timeline

- To return to the original timeline when you're finished, double-click the name of the enclosing timeline in the path control at the bottom left-hand corner of the Timeline.



The path control you can use to close the compound clip

To decompose a compound clip into its individual clips in the Timeline:

- Right-click any compound clip and choose Decompose in Place from the contextual menu. The compound clip is replaced by the individual clips it was made from.

To edit a compound clip from the Media Pool to the Timeline as individual clips:

- 1 Choose Edit > Decompose Compound Clips on Edit so the menu item is checked.
- 2 Use any editing command except for Fit to Fill or Place on Top to edit a compound clip from the Media Pool or Source Viewer to the Timeline to edit it as a sequence of individual, decomposed clips.

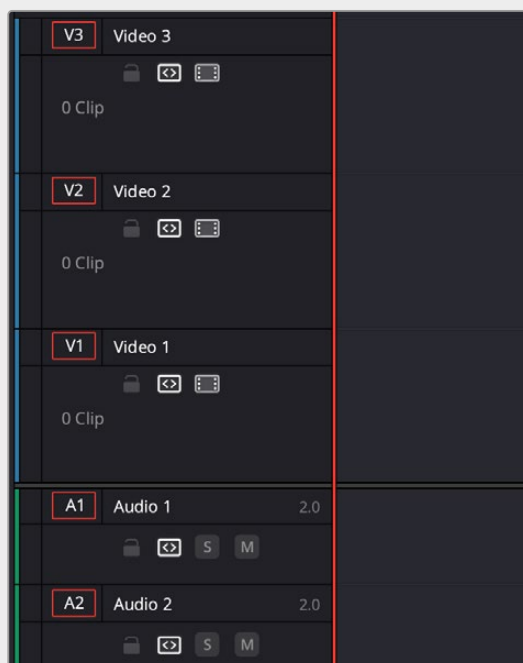
To change the timecode of a compound clip:

You can change the starting timecode for both multicam and compound clips. To do so, right-click on the multicam or compound clip in the Media Pool, and select Starting Timecode from the context menu. A Set New Start Timecode box will appear, then type in the new starting timecode you wish to use, and click OK.

Individual Destination Controls with Decompose on Edit

In Edit > Edit Options, when the setting to Decompose Compound Clips on Edit is enabled, compound clips and timelines either selected in the Media Pool or loaded in the Source Viewer have support for track destination controls from the underlying clip.

This means that if a timeline with three video tracks and two audio tracks is loaded into the Source Viewer, the timeline track destination controls will show three available video tracks and two available audio tracks for track destination patching.



With Edit > Edit Options > Decompose Compound Clips on Edit enabled, the resulting tracks available for track destination tracking

Compositing With and Grading Compound Clips

Since compound clips act like a single clip in the Timeline, they appear as a single MediaIn node in the Fusion page, and you can grade them as a single clip in the Color page. However, if you want to individually apply effects, adjust the RAW camera settings, or grade the original clips inside the compound clip, you can use the Open in Timeline command to access its constituent clips, and then open the Fusion or Color pages, where you'll find each of the individual clips available for separate compositing or grading. When you're done, go back to the Edit page and close the compound clip, and you'll go back to seeing it as a single clip whenever you open the Fusion and Color pages.

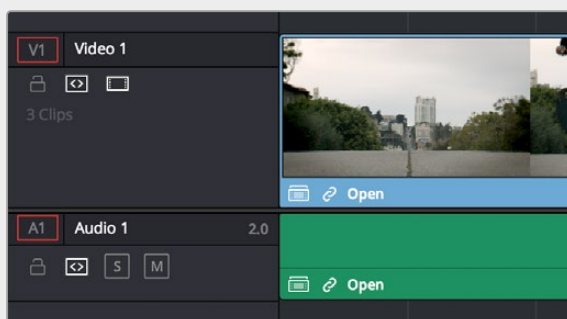
Nested Timelines

Timelines, and sections of timelines, can be edited inside other timelines, either partially or whole. For example, if you've edited a program in scenes or reels such that each reel is contained in a separate timeline, you can edit all of the timelines together, one after the other, into a single timeline to assemble them into a final program.



Multiple timelines edited together into a single sequence

Nested timeline clips appear with a special badge to the left of the timeline name.



The badge that indicates a nested timeline

Timelines can be edited like any other clip, you can select one or more timelines and drag and drop them into another timeline, drag them onto the Timeline Viewer editing overlay, or use the toolbar editing buttons or keyboard shortcuts to edit them, just as you would any other clip.

Additionally, you can select multiple timelines in the Media Pool, right-click them, and choose Create Timeline Using Selected Clips to quickly assemble a group of timelines into a nested sequence.

The one exception is that you must drag and drop a timeline into the Viewer if you want to use it to set In and Out points, since double-clicking a timeline, or selecting a timeline and pressing Return simply opens it into the Timeline Editor. However, you can set In and Out points for timelines in the Filmstrip of the Media Pool, or you can edit a timeline into another timeline in its entirety, and then trim the head and tail down to just what you need. Double-clicking a nested timeline opens it into the Source Viewer for trimming, exactly like any other clip.

Re-Editing a Nested Timeline

If you want to edit the contents of a nested timeline, you can right-click it and choose Open in Timeline. Unlike compound clips, no path control appears when you do this, because you've simply opened the original timeline. To go back to the previous timeline, find and double-click it in the Media Pool, or choose it from the Timeline drop-down at the top of the Timeline Viewer.

Editing an original timeline does nothing to change the duration of nested instances of that timeline inside other timelines. If you trim or delete clips in the original timeline that appear in nested instances of that timeline, then those areas of the nested timeline simply go black.

Swapping the Contents of the Source Viewer and Timeline

When editing the partial contents of one timeline into another, it can be useful to see the contents of a timeline that's open in the Source Viewer in the Timeline Editor. To do so, choose Timeline > Swap Timeline and Source Viewer (Command-Page Up). This puts the timeline that was open in the Source Viewer into the Timeline Editor, and the timeline that was in the Timeline Editor into the Source Viewer. This makes it easier to mark In and Out points while seeing the exact boundaries of clips, prior to pressing Command-Page Up to swap the contents of the Source Viewer and Timeline Editor once again in preparation for executing the next edit.

Editing Source Media From a Timeline or Compound Clip

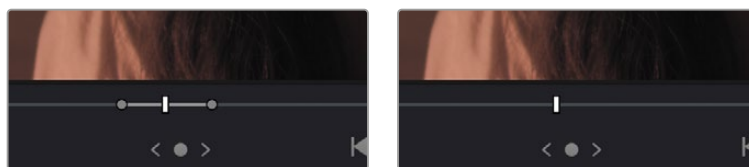
If you have a timeline that has clips you want to edit into another timeline, but as source clips and not as nested timeline segments, you can turn on Edit > Decompose Compound Clips on Edit.

This a mode determines whether a timeline is edited into another timeline as a nested timeline, or immediately decomposed into its constituent source clips. Turning this mode on lets you edit source clips from a timeline using drag and drop, 3-point edits, or whatever other method you find convenient. To go back to editing nested timelines, turn Edit > Decompose Compound Clips on Edit off.

This mode is especially useful for workflows where you're assembling "selects" timelines with the best moments of various interviews or performances, which you later want to edit as sources into the actual program you're editing.

Marking Clips in Timelines Loaded into the Source Viewer

While you're editing Source Media from a timeline that's loaded into the Source Viewer, you can use the Mark Clip (the X key) to set Viewer In and Out points that match the start and end of whatever clip intersects the playhead within that timeline. This makes it easy to edit one clip from a Timeline in the Viewer into your program, all by itself.



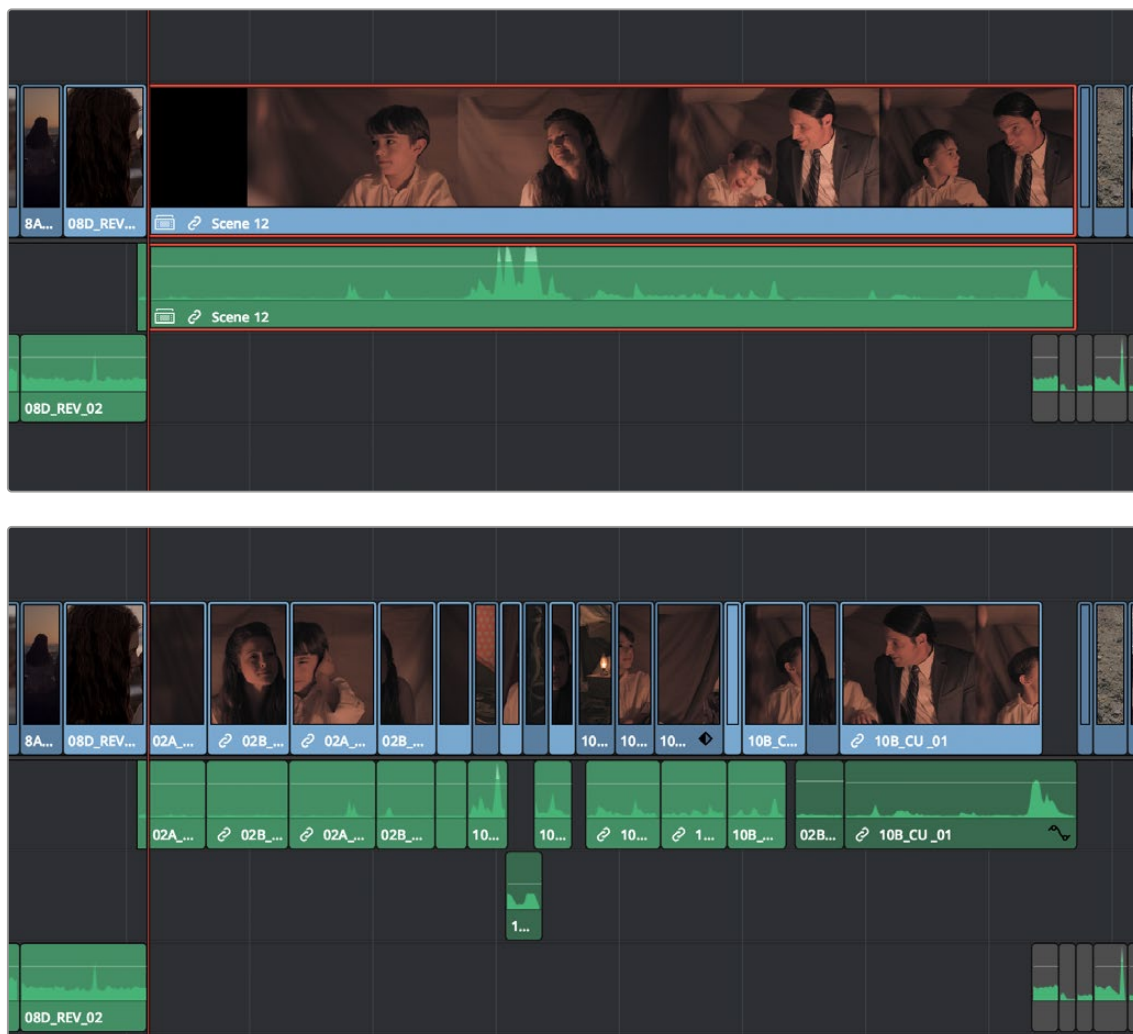
(Left) A timeline in the Source Viewer, (Right) Pressing X marks In and Out points for the clip at the playhead, ready for editing

Decomposing Nested Timelines

There are two main ways you can turn a nested timeline back into its constituent clips.

Decomposing in Place

To decompose a nested timeline that's already been edited into another timeline, right-click it and choose Decompose in Place. You can also do this for multiple selected nested timelines, all at once.



(Top) A nested timeline, (Bottom) The result of using Decompose In Place

If the decomposed clip has more audio, video, or subtitle tracks as a result, then additional tracks will be added to the Timeline to make room. If this is a problem, you can rearrange the clips

Decomposing Nested Timelines While Editing

If you want to edit an entire timeline into another timeline solely as the source clips, you can turn on Edit > Decompose Compound Clips on Edit, and then edit that timeline into your program using whatever method you find convenient, as described previously in this chapter.

Compositing and Grading Nested Timelines

Similarly to compound clips, nested timelines act like a single clip in the Timeline; they appear as a single MediaIn node in the Fusion page for compositing, and you can grade them as a single clip in the Color page. However, if you want to individually add effects to or grade the original clips inside a nested timeline, you can either open that timeline from the Media Pool, or right-click that clip and choose Open in Timeline in order to access its constituent clips for compositing or grading.

Audio Buses in Nested Timelines

When you nest a timeline inside of another timeline that has buses set up for mixing in the Fairlight page, all Sub and Aux routings work as intended within the nested timeline, which exposes all channels of Main 1 in the enclosing timeline. In this sense, the audio of the nested timeline can be considered to be a submix that outputs its resulting audio to the audio track it's edited onto.

For more information about Buses and audio mixing in general, see Part 13, “Fairlight.”

Match Frame for Nested Timelines and Compound Clips

Match Frame to Source Clip feature is supported for compound clips as well as nested timelines. Based on the context, the relevant underlying source clip is loaded into the Source Viewer.

With a compound clip or timeline loaded in the Source Viewer, when performing a match frame (from the Source Viewer), DaVinci Resolve prioritizes finding a nested copy of the clip in the timeline to perform the match frame. If a nested copy is not found, match frame is automatically performed to match the underlying source clip to a timeline instance.

Similarly, when the match frame is performed from the timeline (or timeline viewer), DaVinci Resolve first attempts to find the same underlying clip and frame in the compound clip or nested timeline loaded in the Source Viewer. If the frame cannot be found, then match frame to source is automatically performed as usual. This is especially useful when you are comparing two different versions of a timeline and going back and forth.

Converting Compound Clips or Timelines to Multicam Clips

It's possible to convert compound clips and timelines into multicam clips for easier editing using the Edit page's Multicam Editing interface. This conversion is a one-way process. You cannot reconvert a multicam clip back to a timeline or compound clip. If you wish to preserve the original timeline or compound clip, make sure to duplicate it first, and then convert the copy.

For more information, see *Chapter 42, “Multicam Editing.”*

To convert a compound clip or timeline to a Multicam clip:

- Right-click on the clip or timeline in the Media Pool and choose “Convert Compound Clips (Timelines) to Multicam Clips” from the drop down menu.